

Maya Durbar

Her core team is a mix of the old and the new but what they all have in common is unflinching loyalty and commitment to the leader



SATISH CHANDRA MISHRA

The man behind the social engineering that saw the BSP get a majority all on its own. He advised Mayawati to capitalise on the Brahmins' disenchantment with the Congress; did all the groundwork to establish an alliance with the UNPA and the Left parties. Will accompany her on tours to spread message of *Sarva Samaj*.



SHASHANK S. SINGH

He is the only bureaucrat in any state to hold the post of cabinet secretary. Had been the seniormost principal secretary of the state. The eyes and ears of the Government, he has Mayawati's confidence and full backing and runs the administration leaving the chief minister with the time and the opportunity to spread the BSP's larger message.

this one is not a mere decorative piece, in spite of all that bling. Her politics is her biography, a narrative that combines the worst impulses of Indian society and the best of Indian democracy. Her ambition broke the barriers of castiest India, and at 39, she became the chief minister of Uttar Pradesh, where politics is nasty, masculine and violent. And the state is also India's most productive prime-minister factory. Today, Mayawati, at 52, is a four-time chief minister, the highest diva of Dalits, one of the country's smartest politicians with a direct access to her voters' conscience, and one of the most powerful women in the world. It is pretty natural for such a politician to tap the possibilities of Indian democracy, which is elastic enough to accommodate almost every type. She asks: "If I am fit to rule the largest state of India, why can't I run the whole country?" (See interview)

A.B. BARDHAN
CPI general secretary

“Mayawati can be a fit and better candidate than many others waiting to be prime minister. The new coalition of 10 parties can be an alternative to Congress and BJP.”

SANJAY SONKAR

